

The Analects (論語)

Confucius (孔子) · James Legge (1893)

Book I — 學而 (Xue Er)

子曰：「學而時習之，不亦說乎？有朋自遠方來，不亦樂乎？人不知而不愠，不亦君子乎？」

The Master said, 'Is it not pleasant to learn with a constant perseverance and application? Is it not delightful to have friends coming from distant quarters? Is he not a man of complete virtue, who feels no discomposure though men may take no note of him?'

子曰：「巧言令色，鮮矣仁！」

The Master said, 'Fine words and an insinuating appearance are seldom associated with true virtue.'

曾子曰：「吾日三省吾身：為人謀而不忠乎？與朋友交而不信乎？傳不習乎？」

The philosopher Tsang said, 'I daily examine myself on three points: — whether, in transacting business for others, I may have been not faithful; — whether, in intercourse with friends, I may have been not sincere; — whether I may have not mastered and practised the instructions of my teacher.'

Translation by James Legge, *The Chinese Classics*, vol. 1 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1893). This translation is in the public domain.